

FOR THE TEACHER

Teacher Guide & Answer Key



Lead Your AI Squad — why it works, an exemplar for every student item (quest card, all three roles, a filled CHECK row and note, the exit ticket), what-ifs, and the taught/assessed standards map.

WHY THIS LESSON

It stands alone — every skill it uses is re-taught in miniature on the page. The idea: **an AI agent does a whole job, step by step, on its own — and if your card leaves something out, the agent usually fills the gap with a guess and keeps going.** Some tools stop and ask instead; both behaviours are worth naming. A good AI job runs **human** → **AI** → **human**, so the human job moves from doing the work to leading it: you write the quest card, the AI does the middle, you check the loot before it ships. For the adults in the room, a quest card is what work calls a brief, and this loop is delegation — a skill students may one day use to run real projects and real AI tools; nobody can promise how those tools will look.

EXEMPLAR QUEST CARDS (BOTH QUESTS; GAME NIGHT IS THE BOARD MODEL)

GOAL: get 6th graders to actually show up to Game Night. **WHAT WE KNOW:** Friday, gym, 6–8 pm; we have board games and two TVs. **RULES OF THE RUN:** school-appropriate, big readable title, 40 words max. **DONE LOOKS LIKE:** one flyer draft, ready to photocopy.

Class Magazine, issue #1 (the other quest): **GOAL:** get every 6th-grade homeroom to read issue #1. **WHAT WE KNOW:** one class period a week for three weeks; 24 writers; the library printer is black and white. **RULES OF THE RUN:** 8 pages, school-appropriate, nobody is named without being asked first. **DONE LOOKS LIKE:** a page-by-page plan with a writer's name on every page.

How to score any quest card (Step 2 and Exit #1): hand it to the most literal reader in the room. If they can twist it, or have to guess, a part is missing or vague. **Proficient** = all four parts, specific enough that a stranger could do it tomorrow. **Developing** = parts present but vague ("make it good," "soon"). **Beginning** = a wish, not a quest card ("help me with math").

SUPPORT & ELL: QUEST CARD SENTENCE STARTERS

GOAL: "When this quest is done, ____ will happen." · **WHAT WE KNOW:** "This is for _____. The team already has _____."

RULES OF THE RUN: "It must _____. It must NOT _____. Due _____." · **DONE LOOKS LIKE:** "Hand back a _____ (flyer / list / plan / paragraph)."

ELL students may draft the card in their strongest language first, then translate — the four labels double as language frames.

EXEMPLAR SQUAD OUTPUT (STEP 3 — SANA'S SQUAD, GAME NIGHT CARD)

ROLE	WHAT GOOD OUTPUT LOOKS LIKE
Planner (DeShawn)	1. Pick the games and the TV set-up (5 min). 2. Write the flyer title and the when/where line (5 min). 3. ★ Add a 40-word pitch (10 min). 4. Count the words, check every rule (3 min). 5. NOT ON THE CARD: who photocopies it, and how many? <i>Score: numbered and timed, one step starred, and the flag instead of a guess — the flags are gold; they're the next card's fixes. The numbers don't have to be right; the habit of guessing them is what scores.</i>
Scout (Lucia)	Friday ✓ (on the card) · gym ✓ (on the card) · 6–8 pm ✓ (on the card) · both TVs actually work? ? (ask whoever runs the gym) · how many 6th graders there are ? (the front office). <i>Score: every ✓ has a "how we know"; every ? has a "where to check." A fact with neither is a guess wearing a costume. Class Magazine version: three weeks ✓ (on the card) · 24 writers ✓ (on the card) · does the library printer do color? ? (ask the librarian) · how many homerooms need a copy ? (the front office).</i>
Critic (Sana)	0–4 min, what the audience cares about: which games, and whether friends are going. Upgrades: (1) Put the TVs and the games in the title — 6th graders come for the games, not the date. (2) Cut the 40 words to 25; nobody reads a wall of text on a wall. (3) Add one line for parents: pick-up is at 8. <i>Score: each upgrade names the exact change and ties it to the audience on the card. "Make it better" counts for nothing.</i>

FILLED CHECK ROW + NOTE (STEP 4 — LUCIA REVIEWING DESHAWN'S PLAN)

CHECK	EVIDENCE	VERDICT
ACCURACY	"Steps 1–4 use Friday, gym, 6–8 pm straight off the card."	SHIP IT
TASTE	"Step 3 says 'write the pitch' but never says to 6th graders — it could be for anybody."	RUN IT BACK
DONE-NESS	"All four card parts are covered, and the NOT ON THE CARD flag is a plus."	SHIP IT

KEEP: "Every step has a time guess and all four card parts are covered." **FIX:** "Step 3 needs the words 'for 6th graders' — the card names the audience and the plan dropped it." *Score: evidence is quoted or pointed to, one verdict per check, and the FIX names the exact change plus why. A note that says "good job, be more specific" is a RUN IT BACK on the leader.*

Rotation: Sit in a triangle. The Scout sits on the Planner's left; the Critic sits on the Scout's left. Every paper moves one seat to its owner's left — the Planner's plan goes to the Scout, the Scout's questions go to the Critic, the Critic's list goes to the Planner. The Critic never reviews the Planner's list in Step 4 — they already read it at the 4-minute call. In the last 60 seconds of the block, each leader hands the paper back and reads their FIX line to its owner.

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✓ ANSWER KEY — EXIT TICKET (WORKSHEET P.3)

ITEM	WHAT A GOOD ANSWER LOOKS LIKE
#1 — quest card for a real task (<i>Objective 1</i>)	Exemplar (a study plan): GOAL: pass Friday's fractions quiz with at least a B. WHAT WE KNOW: 7th grade math; I have the review sheet and 30 minutes a night, Monday to Thursday. RULES OF THE RUN: only fractions with different denominators, no calculator, nothing due before Wednesday. DONE LOOKS LIKE: a four-night plan, 5 practice problems a night, answers on a separate line. Score with the quest-card scale on p.1.
#2 — which role first, and why (<i>Objective 2</i>)	Any role earns credit if the reason fits the task: <i>scout</i> first for a fact-heavy flyer ("I need the real dates before anyone plans"); <i>planner</i> first for a schedule ("the steps ARE the job"); <i>critic</i> first when the audience is picky ("my little brother won't follow a boring chore list"). The reason is what scores; a role with no reason is Developing.
#3 — the check it would most likely fail (<i>Objective 3</i>)	Any check with something real to look for: "ACCURACY — the quiz date and which chapter"; "TASTE — is it written for a 12-year-old or for a teacher?"; "DONE-NESS — did it give all four nights, or stop at two?" Proficient names the check AND the specific thing to look for; a check alone is Developing.

WHEN IT GOES SIDEWAYS

The class doesn't divide by 3 → a team of 4 runs two critics (both read the plan; they'll disagree — great). A team of 2 drops the critic; the leader does the taste check personally.

A leader turns harsh → KEEP before FIX, and the leader reads the note aloud to their party member.

A team finishes early → rewrite the quest card so tight the critic can't land a note — or design a fourth squad role and its one-line job.

A card is hopelessly vague and the squad stalls → don't rescue it. "It's not on the card" is the only mid-round answer; in Leader review the RUN IT BACK lands on the card, not the party member. That public, fixable failure is the lesson. (With devices: the projected AI invents a fact — best case. "Which missing rule let it do that?" Add it, run it again.)

FULL STANDARDS TEXT

- **ISTE 1.5.c** — Students break problems into component parts, extract key information, and develop descriptive models to understand complex systems or facilitate problem-solving. *Taught: the Party Leader's Loop instruction (a project broken into four card parts and three roles). Assessed: the Step 2 quest card and Exit Ticket #1, scored with the quest-card scale on p.1.*
- **ISTE 1.7.c** — Students contribute constructively to project teams, assuming various roles and responsibilities to work effectively toward a common goal. *Taught: Run the Quest (every student works one role, then leads one review). Assessed: the Step 3 role output (scored against the exemplar squad output, p.2), the Step 4 CHECK rubric and run-it-back note, and Exit Ticket #2.*
- **CCSS ELA W.6.4** — Produce clear and coherent writing in which the development, organization, and style are appropriate to task, purpose, and audience. (Grade-specific expectations for writing types are defined in standards 1-3 above.) *Taught: quest-card modeling in direct instruction (goal, audience, rules, output). Assessed: Exit Ticket #1 — a four-part quest card written for a real task and audience, scored Proficient / Developing / Beginning.*